

Digital Literacy Project Report

- **Name:** Asutosh Behera
- **Registration No.:** 25BEC10067
 - **Branch:** B.Tech ECE
 - **Year:** First Year
- **Course Code:** CSE0001
- **Course Title:** Digital Literacy
 - **Date:** March 31, 2026

Introduction

This project was undertaken in the role of a Student Digital Ambassador at VIT Bhopal University. The primary objective is to assist peers in navigating the complexities of the digital world, ranging from building professional online identities to ensuring safe and responsible communication. This report documents the creation of a Digital Literacy Portfolio organized within a GitHub repository. By completing five distinct tasks—covering infographics, professional portfolios, coding platforms, email etiquette, and cybercrime awareness—I have developed a foundational understanding of the tools and behaviors necessary for a successful and secure digital academic life. The portfolio serves as a permanent resource for my personal and professional growth.

Task 1 Write-up: Digital Literacy Awareness Infographic

For the first task, I created a one-page visual resource intended to help my batchmates understand the core pillars of digital literacy. I utilized **Canva** to design the infographic because of its user-friendly interface and professional templates. My design covers three essential topics: what digital literacy encompasses, safe internet practices (such as verifying sources), and the importance of professional email etiquette. The visual emphasizes that digital literacy is not just about using tools, but about using them responsibly and critically. One thing I found particularly interesting was the challenge of condensing complex information into a single page without losing clarity. Balancing icons with text required careful thought to ensure the resource remained engaging and easy to digest for students.

Task 2 Write-up: Student Digital Portfolio

In this task, I established my foundational professional presence on **GitHub**, **LinkedIn**, and **HackerRank**. On GitHub, I created a profile README containing my branch, year, and academic goals. On LinkedIn, I updated my education section to reflect my current status at VIT Bhopal. These platforms serve different purposes: LinkedIn is my professional resume and networking hub, while GitHub and HackerRank showcase my technical skills and coding progress. Over the next four years, I plan to use these platforms to document my projects, share my learning journey, and eventually connect with potential internship coordinators and employers. Keeping these profiles professional and minimal at this early stage allows me to build a consistent "digital footprint" that will evolve with my technical expertise.

Task 3 Write-up: Coding & Collaboration Platforms

To build familiarity with essential technical tools, I engaged with both coding practice platforms and cloud collaboration tools. I used **HackerRank** to complete a beginner-level Python challenge, which helped me practice basic syntax and problem-solving. For the collaboration component, I created a **Google Form** titled "Digital Literacy Awareness Quiz". This quiz features five questions, including multiple-choice and short-answer formats, designed to test my peers' knowledge of online safety. I also linked the responses to a Google Sheet to practice data management. These tools are academically vital; coding platforms prepare me for technical interviews, while Google Workspace tools enable seamless collaboration on group projects and research.

Task 4 Write-up: Professional Email & Etiquette Guide

This task focused on professional communication and responsible social media use. I drafted two professional emails: one requesting a deadline extension from a professor and another inquiring about a summer internship opportunity. Both emails were structured with clear subject lines and formal sign-offs to ensure a respectful tone. Additionally, I compiled a social media checklist of 5 "Do's" and 5 "Don'ts," emphasizing the "Billboard Test" and the permanence of digital footprints. One hypothetical situation where poor communication causes issues is when a student vents about a professor on social media; this can lead to disciplinary action and damage future job prospects. Learning to separate personal frustrations from public digital spaces is a critical professional skill.

Task 5 Write-up: Cybercrime Awareness & Prevention

For the final task, I researched **UPI/Online Payment Fraud**, specifically the "Pending Utility Bill" scam. I documented how scammers use social engineering and remote-access apps to trick victims into revealing their UPI PINs. What surprised me most was how easily criminals exploit a victim's sense of urgency and panic. I also developed a "Stay Safe Online" guide featuring eight actionable tips, such as verifying "Collect Requests" and using two-factor authentication. As a result of this research, I have personally committed to the habit of always using mobile data instead of public Wi-Fi for any financial transactions to prevent data interception.

Conclusion

This project has been a comprehensive introduction to the responsibilities of a digital citizen. Moving through the modules, I transitioned from a passive user of technology to an active, professional Student Digital Ambassador. I have learned that digital literacy is a combination of technical proficiency, such as managing a GitHub repository, and soft skills, such as professional email etiquette and cyber safety awareness. These skills will not only help me navigate my four-year degree at VIT Bhopal but will also serve as the foundation for my future career in Cyber Security.